surely, the Hindu way of life—yoga, Ayurvedic remedies to boost immunity, vipasana getaways and karmic consciousness—are gaining increasing popularity amongst an overtired Gen Z looking for a way to escape the click-bait media-induced anxiety. The fact that Hinduism does not forcefully convert, is tolerant and allows flexibility to follow the path one connects with seem to attract millennial folk—an occurrence upsetting other dominant, extreme religious groups worldwide. The angles of the pictures shot at the Kumbh and the accompanying narratives written for pieces which would be widely circulated globally were put together with a clear mocking tone for the Hindu way and customs. The stories were braggadocio and overhyped with an apparent ridicule for the Modi government that promotes them.

In contrast, a Muslim cleric's funeral in UP saw tens and thousands of unmasked people in attendance just a week after the Kumbh.[14] However, that episode warranted barely any mention in media outlets.

Likewise, in the last week of March when Punjab had India's highest COVID-19 mortality rate and was witnessing a rapid surge in cases, thousands of Sikh devotees gathered in the city of Anandpur Sahib to celebrate the Hola Mohalla festival. Media houses reporting from ground found that neither any COVID-19 protocols were being followed in the festival grounds nor inside the premises of the main gurudwara, Takhat Sri Kesgarh Sahib.[15] The president of the Sikh Gurdwara Parbandhak Committee (SGPC), an organization which manages Sikh places of worship, quashed the government's proposal to ask devotees to present a negative COVID-19 report before entering the festival and further said that it will not suspend any religious congregation.[16] Despite this, there was barely any media outcry or bashing of the Sikh traditions among voices which seemed quite vocal in expressing their reservations about the Kumbha Mela.

Several comparisons were made in the media about the handling of the Tablighi Jamaat episode and that of the Kumbha Mela. In both events, the prime minister chose not to use force to disburse the crowd and instead appeal to the religious heads, either himself or by deputing Doval in the case of the Tablighi episode. In both episodes, he gave the states the first right to manage the situation using their law-and-order machinery; intervening only when it went out of hand of the respective state's leadership. Once again, when only after his intervention the Kumbha Mela